

â We go home to marry, my Princess.â

As in get married?

To *him*?

Suddenly, I thought of all those girlish fantasies Iâ d had before I learned who I was and what was expected of meâ daydreams given life because of the love my parents had for one another.

Never once did those little-girl dreams include a proposal that wasnâ t remotely an actual proposal. Nor did they incorporate it being announced at a table full of strangers, half of which wanted me dead.

And those dreams surely hadnâ t involved what had to be the kingdomâ s worstâ and possibly most insaneâ non-proposal of marriage to a man currently holding me captive.

Perhaps I had some sort of ailment of the brain. Maybe I was experiencing hallucinations brought on by stress. After all, there had been so much painful death to process. His betrayal to deal with.